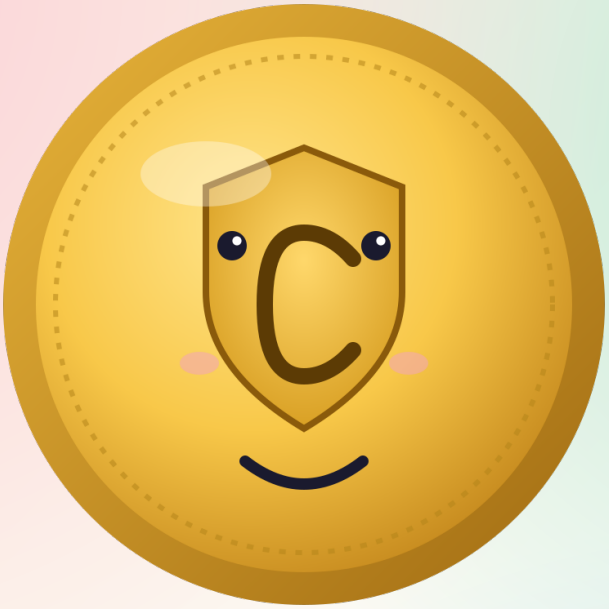


GRADE 1

Parent Guide

C A S H

Businesses make things or do things

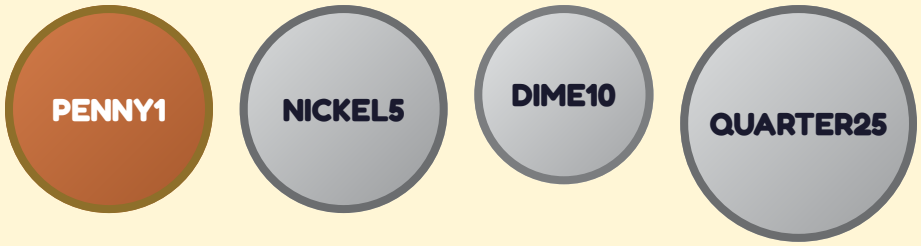
One good question per quarter, family-friendly.

Grade 1 — Cash to Company: Parent and Caregiver Guide

A short, warm guide for the adult who lives with a Grade 1 Cash to Company student.

What this year is

This year, your first grader is learning to **sort businesses** and **count coins**. Some helpers **make a thing** — the bakery makes bread, the lemonade stand makes lemonade. Some helpers **do a thing** — the librarian shelves books, the dog walker walks dogs. Many do both. That's the year's good first puzzle.



We also count coins. Last year, your child named four coins (penny, nickel, dime, quarter). This year, they put coins on a mat and add them up. Two dimes and a nickel — twenty-five cents. That is the year's whole money task.

We follow 4-step recipe cards (paper bookmarks, trail mix). We talk about what makes a good sign (name, item, price). We talk about what it means

to keep a promise. We open a Classroom Store in the corner of the room where children take turns being workers and customers, and we close the year with a Family Visit Day.

That is it. We do not teach pricing or profit. Those come later. This year is mostly play and sorting.

What your child is bringing home

You may see:

- A **drawing of a business** — a bakery, a barber shop, a dog walker — sorted as MAKE or DO.
- A **Coin Mat Booklet** — five small coin combinations and the totals (e.g., quarter + dime = 35¢).
- A **4-Step Recipe Card** — a card the child wrote that lists four steps for making something small.
- A **sign for a pretend stand** — your child's name, an item, and a price.
- An invitation to **Family Visit Day** at the end of the year.

Your child may say things like "that one MAKES — it's a bakery" or "two dimes is twenty" or "the worker says 'how can I help you?'" These are the year's wins.

CASH SAYS

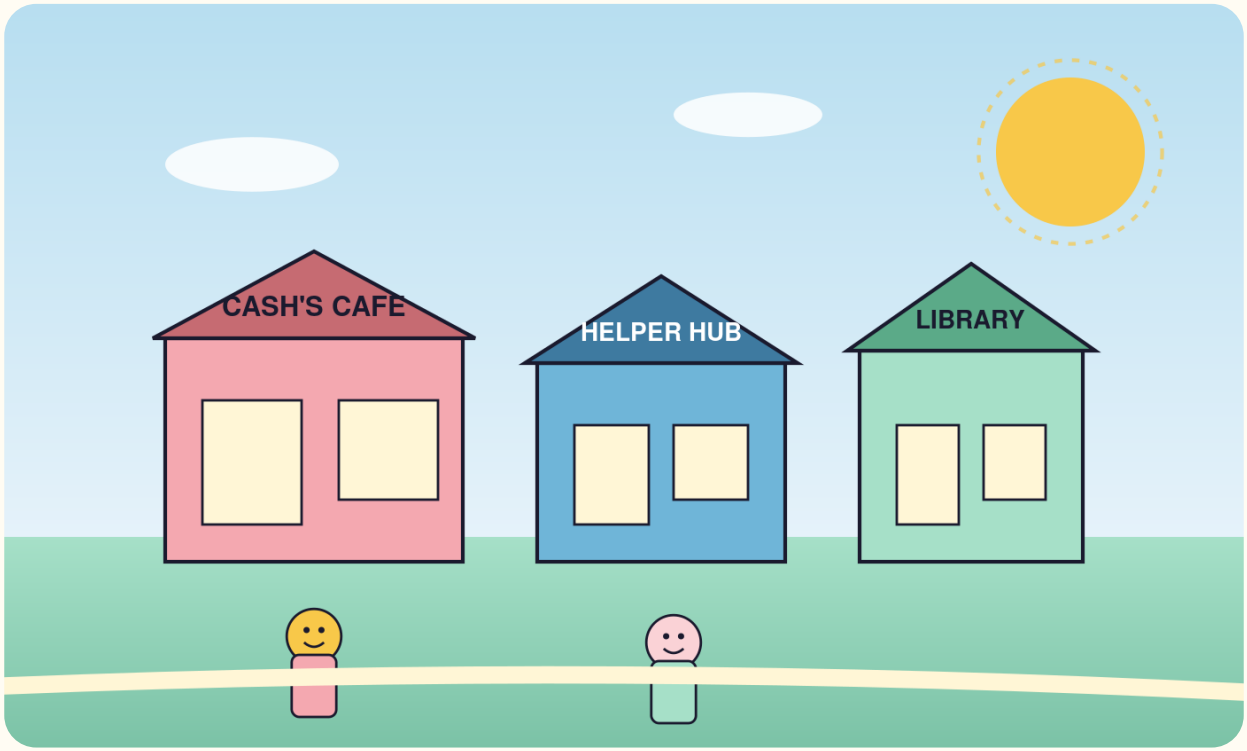
Which coin is more? Show me with your hands.

What you don't need to do

- **You don't need to teach anything.** A parent with no business background can fully support this year.
- **You don't need to buy anything.** No tools, no books, no supplies are required at home.
- **You don't need to share family financial details.** The curriculum will never ask your child about how much money your family has, what you do for work, or how much things cost in your home. If your child asks you a money question that feels invasive, you can say "that's a grown-up question" — that is a fine answer.

What you can do (if you want)

These are optional and low-effort. None of them are required.



Helpers are everywhere. Each one is a kind of business.

1. Ask one good question per quarter

Try one of these. Listen more than you speak.

- **September–October (Unit 1, Make or do?):** "At our store today, did the worker MAKE a thing or DO a thing? What was it?" Or: "Of all the helpers we saw today, which one made a thing? Which one did a thing?"
- **November–January (Unit 2, Coins on the mat):** "Pretend you have these three coins — a quarter, a dime, and a nickel. How much is that?" Then: "Pretend that ice pop costs 30 cents. Is it enough?" (Always pretend. Never about real coins or real prices in your home.)

- **February–April (Unit 3, Follow the recipe):** "You made something today — what were the four steps? In order." Or: "Tell me about a story where someone kept a promise. What happened?"
- **May–June (Unit 4, The Classroom Store):** "At your Classroom Store, what's on your sign? What's the name? What's the item? What's the price?" And: "What kind word did you use today?"

You don't need to know the answers. You're modeling curiosity. Your child will tell you.

2. Sort businesses together when you're out

When you're at the grocery store, the post office, the library, or the bakery — point and say, "this one — make or do?" Then sort it together. Your child has been doing this all year. They will join in.

3. Use the kind words at home

The year's kind words are please, thank you, and you're welcome. If you make them part of your family's everyday talk, your child will hear the school version and the home version line up.

4. Read a picture book together

Any picture book about a small business or a community helper works. The school library has favorites — Saturday Sancocho, Pancakes, Pancakes!, The Doorbell Rang, Officer Buckle and Gloria. Read slowly. Pause. Ask, "in this story — make or do?"

5. Come to Family Visit Day

Late in the year, the class hosts a Family Visit Day. Your child will show you the Make/Do Sort Wall, read their sign aloud, and play one round at the Classroom Store with you as the customer. If you can't come, the school will pair your child with another grown-up. But if you can come — please do. Bring a pretend coin (or use one of theirs).

CASH SAYS

What comes first? What comes next?

What to watch for

- **Your child starts sorting businesses on their own.** Walking past a bakery: "that's a make." Past a vet: "that's a do." This is the year working.
- **Your child counts coins by sight.** Two dimes and a nickel — twenty-five. They might still mix up the dime and nickel for a while; that's normal. Coins add up — say it back to them: "yes, two dimes and a nickel — twenty-five cents."
- **Your child wants to play "store" at home.** Encourage. A pretend store at the kitchen counter, with cardboard "money" and pretend products, is exactly the work this year is doing. Take a turn as the customer. Use kind words. Count the coins.

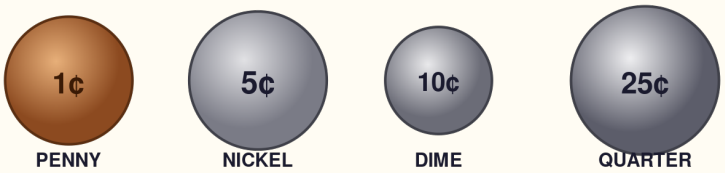
- **Your child uses kind words a little more often.** Even if it's only at school, that's a real win.

A few honest notes

- **Six is still wiggly.** Some lessons land; some don't. By June, the sorting habit and coin counting are what we want — not perfect spelling or perfect signs.
- **This curriculum doesn't promise wealth.** We teach clarity, not wealth. We say helpers help, businesses make and do, and we noticed.
- **If something feels wrong for your family,** tell the teacher. Skip the page. Use a different business example.

CASH SAYS

Tell me what they said with their words.



Penny. Nickel. Dime. Quarter. We say each name out loud.

A short message from Cash

"Hi, family. I'm Cash. Your kid sorted helpers all year. They counted coins on a mat. They followed recipe cards in order. They drew a sign. They took turns at our Classroom Store. They kept promises in stories. They named one thing they would change. Thank you for letting me hang out with them. Notice, notice, notice — that's all I ever ask. See you next year."

If you have questions, your child's teacher is the right person to ask. They have the year's plans, the assessment notes, and the day-to-day picture. They are also a helper. Notice them.

Senior expert upgrade pack — "Spotting on a walk" 3-question script

Here is one ready-to-use script a parent can run on any errand, in 90 seconds, requiring no prep.

Script — "Make or do?"

Walking past a place of business with your Grade 1 child:

You: "Look at this place. What do they do here?" Child: (answers — pizza, books, haircuts, taxes) You: "Do they MAKE a thing here, or DO a thing here?" Child: (answers — pizza is making, haircuts is doing, books is hmm) You: "Hmm. The library — they don't make books. They lend them. So they do a thing."

End. Walk on. You've practiced the year's central sort in 60 seconds. Repeat any day. The repetition is what makes it stick.

Other questions you can ask (no expertise required)

- "What does the sign tell you about this place?"
- "What's the name? What's the item? What's the price?"
- "Who's a helper here? What do they do?"
- "If you had a business in this neighborhood, what would your sign say?"

You don't have to be right. You just have to ask. The teacher does the rest.

CASH SAYS

Notice, notice, notice. What did you see?

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 1)

Quarter 1 (Make or Do) 1. On a walk: "Lets find one helper who makes something and one helper who does something." — Sample answer: "Bakery makes; barber does." 2. In the kitchen: "Are you making a thing or doing a thing right now?" — Sample answer: "Making — Im stirring." — Follow-up: "Could that be a business?" 3. At a checkout: "Did this store make what we

bought, or did someone else?" — Follow-up: "Where do you think it came from?"

Quarter 2 (Counting Coins) 1. With a handful of change: "Can we count up to 50 cents?" — Sample answer: "Yes! Two quarters." — Follow-up: "What other ways?" 2. Pretend store at home: "Im selling this pencil for 30 cents. Do you have enough?" — Follow-up: "What coins did you pick?" 3. Drive-time: "What does a sign with a $ on it tell us?" — Sample answer: "How much it costs." — Follow-up: "What if there was no sign?"

Quarter 3 (Classroom Store) 1. After school: "What did your store sell today?" — Follow-up: "Did you make it or do it?" 2. At dinner: "Tell me about one customer at the store today." — Follow-up: "Did they say thank you?" 3. Walking past a cafe: "What three things does this signs need to have to be helpful?" — Sample answer: "Name. What it sells. Price."

Quarter 4 (One Thing Id Change) 1. After they finish a project: "Whats one thing youd change next time?" — Follow-up: "Why that one?" 2. On a walk: "If you ran a paper-airplane business, would you sell airplanes or teach folding? Why?" — Follow-up: "How would you know its working?" 3. At bedtime: "Did Cash ask you anything today?" — Follow-up: "What did Cash ask?"

Sensitivity: None of these prompts require parents to share home finances. They work whether your family runs a business or not.

CASH

Which people, and how do you know?

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

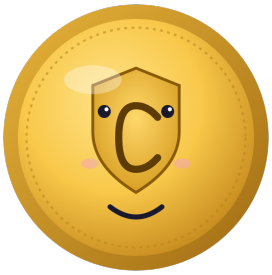
Cash to Companys most distinctive brand promise is the language we dont use. We thought youd want to know.

Cash will never say to your child: - "Amazing!" / "Awesome!" — instead, "okay, thats specific — whats the evidence?" - "Everyone can be rich" — Cash promises clearer thinking, not wealth. - "Easy money" / "Passive income" — Cash names hard things directly. - "Just believe in yourself" as a substitute for evidence. - Anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks instead: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "What did they actually say?" / "Whats the evidence?"

Why this matters at home. Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, including some that lean hustle-bro or get-rich-quick. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side: clear-eyed, honest, and never selling.

One question to ask your child this year: "Did Cash ask you a question this week? What was it?" If your child can name one, the program is landing.



Which people, and how do you know?

— CASH

CASH TO COMPANY

Which people, and how do you know?

Cash is the friendly coin who helps us notice, ask, and try again. Cash will be with us all year. — Grade 1